consciousness movement's appeal to an authentic black identity in South Africa."[15]

Although substantial opposition to the new Islamism persisted among conservative Muslims, the new radical forces certainly made an impact. Study programs and camps were initiated, and manuals printed. Much of the material was provided by Islamic groups abroad, targeting Zionism, secularism, capitalism, and communism as the major threats to Islam.[16] Added impetus was provided by the success of the Iranian revolution in 1979. In its wake, the writings of Ali Shari'ati (1933–1977) and the Ayatollah Khomeini were included on Muslim Youth Movement reading lists. Although Iran was not seen as a model for South African Muslims, Qibla, an Islamist movement founded in 1980, was patently inspired by the overthrow of the Shah. Three years later this movement objected to the creation of the United Democratic Front—an anti-apartheid umbrella movement that included progressive Jewish organizations. Described as Zionist-controlled and operating at the behest of the international Jewish financial conspiracy, Qibla was able to tap into a deep-rooted anger that identified Zionism as the "citadel of imperialism."[17] Indeed, for some observers, Jewish and Zionist manipulation was even responsible for apartheid.[18] Qibla also opposed the negotiated settlement between the ANC and the South African government and, shortly before the first democratic elections in 1994, its leader, Achmat Cassiem, founded the Islamic Unity Convention, a movement that claimed to be constituted of 200 groups, although in essence it was a front for marginalized religious figures and a few small organisations who accepted the pre-eminence of Qibla and its leader.[19]

Yet even if Qibla was a minority movement, many of its antisemitic and anti-Zionist ideas were widespread. The Muslim press, for example, regularly wrote about international financial machinations centred on Zionism and accused Jews of supporting and influencing the apartheid state. Even those Jews committed to the struggle against apartheid were never fully trusted. Radicalization was evident in well-organised Al Quds Day events. The Jewish State was a focus of evil and a conspiratorial center, rooted in the Zionist movement. Its record on human rights abuse was condemned, while the Qibla-inspired PAGAD (People Against Drugs and Gangsterism)—a vigilante movement built upon mounting despair as law and order broke down in the aftermath of apartheid's demise and the loosening of the police state—appeared to provide solutions.[20]

Muslim writings reflected an increasingly paranoid cast of mind, accusing Jews of pulling all the strings.[21] Global events, strong associations with Muslims in the Middle and Near East, and local contestations around

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